

# Xtrata Proof of Session

## A provenance, agreement and collaboration layer for existing music software

The first version of Xtrata for music production does not need to replace Logic, Ableton, Pro Tools or any other DAW.

Instead, it could sit alongside them as a lightweight provenance and agreement layer that gives each music project a persistent identity, records who has participated in it, captures what those people have agreed, and creates a tamper-evident history of how the project has developed.

The agreement could be deliberately simple or as detailed as the collaborators need.

At the beginning of a session, the participants might only confirm:

We acknowledge that we participated in the creation or development of this music project on 23 July 2026.

Alternatively, they could agree:

We confirm that this composition is owned equally between the four named writers, with each writer receiving 25%.

Or:

We agree to the credits, ownership percentages, royalty splits and project terms attached to this Project Passport.

The system should not force every project into the same type of agreement. Its purpose would be to let collaborators clearly record what they have agreed, from a basic acknowledgement of participation through to a complete split sheet or collaboration agreement.

At its heart, Xtrata would establish:

**This project existed at this time, these people were involved, this is what they agreed, and this is the history from which the current work developed.**

## The core object: a Project Passport

When somebody starts a new song, they create an **Xtrata Project Passport**.

The passport could contain:

- A unique project ID
- The working title
- The DAW and project format

- The creation date
- A hash of the original project file
- The creator's wallet or identity
- The wallets or identities of the initial collaborators
- The participants' roles
- The credits agreed so far
- Any ownership or royalty percentages
- The terms being signed
- Links to supporting documents or agreements
- The status of each participant's approval

The creator could choose an agreement template when establishing the project.

## **Agreement modes**

### **Participation record**

The participants confirm that they were involved in the project or session.

This could be useful when it is too early to decide credits or percentages but everyone wants a reliable record that the collaboration took place.

### **Equal split**

The participants agree that ownership, songwriting or another defined interest will be divided equally between them.

For example:

The four named writers agree to divide the composition equally, with each writer receiving 25%.

### **Custom split**

The participants enter and approve individual percentages.

For example:

- Writer A: 40%
- Writer B: 30%
- Writer C: 20%
- Writer D: 10%

The system could check automatically that the percentages total 100%.

### **Credit agreement**

The participants approve roles and credits without necessarily setting financial percentages.

These could include:

- Songwriter
- Composer
- Lyricist
- Producer
- Co-producer
- Vocalist
- Instrumentalist
- Engineer
- Mixer
- Mastering engineer
- Arranger
- Programmer

### **Session terms**

The participants agree to terms that apply only to a particular session or contribution.

For example:

- A musician is being paid a fixed session fee
- A producer is receiving points on the master
- A vocalist retains approval over the final release
- A sample may only be used in a specific version
- A contribution is made as work for hire
- A collaborator is entitled to a defined royalty
- Expenses must be recovered before revenue is divided

### **Full project agreement**

The Project Passport links to or contains a more detailed collaboration agreement covering ownership, royalties, approvals, credits, licensing, expenses, confidentiality or dispute procedures.

Xtrata would provide the evidence trail showing which version was signed, who signed it and when.

## **Agreements can evolve**

Music projects often begin before the participants know exactly what the final credits or percentages should be.

The Project Passport should therefore support progressive agreement.

A project might begin with:

We acknowledge that A, B and C participated in today's writing session.

It could later be updated to:

A, B and C agree in principle to an equal three-way composition split.

The final agreement might then state:

The composition is owned equally between A, B and C. The master is owned by A, with B receiving three producer points and C receiving the agreed session fee.

Each new agreement would be recorded as a new version rather than silently replacing the previous one.

The history would show:

- What was proposed
- Who proposed it
- Who approved it
- Who has not yet responded
- What changed between versions
- Which agreement is currently active
- Whether every required participant has signed

This would make the negotiation process clearer without pretending that every decision must be made before the first note is recorded.

## Signing the Project Passport

Everyone in the room could scan a QR code or open a signing link.

They could sign using:

- A Stacks wallet
- A passkey
- An existing Xtrata identity
- A temporary guest identity
- A conventional electronic signature
- A verified email or mobile confirmation

Participants should not need to understand blockchain technology or hold STX.

Xtrata could collect the signatures off-chain and submit them together in a sponsored transaction. This would allow the project to create strong evidence without asking every collaborator to purchase tokens or pay an individual network fee.

The signed record could include:

- The exact statement or agreement
- The relevant project
- The agreement version
- The signer's identity
- The date and time
- The method of signing
- A hash of any attached terms
- The signer's approval status

## What happens while the song is being made

Once enabled, the Xtrata layer would remain associated with the project.

Every time the project is saved, the system could create a new local checkpoint. It would not upload the project or create an on-chain transaction every time.

Instead, it could record:

- The current project-file hash
- The previous checkpoint hash
- The time of the save
- The identity of the active user, where known
- Whether audio files, collaborators or other important elements have changed
- Whether the current project still matches the recognised lineage
- A short optional note such as “first vocal session” or “drums replaced”

Each checkpoint would include the hash of the previous checkpoint, creating a local chain of project history.

This history would be tamper-evident. Records could still be deleted or altered, but doing so would break the chain and make the interruption visible.

## Contribution records

A checkpoint could also contain optional contribution notes.

For example:

- A wrote the chorus lyric
- B recorded the lead guitar
- C rebuilt the drum arrangement
- D supplied the original vocal sample
- E mixed version 12
- F approved the final master

These records would not need to be created for every edit. They could be added when a contribution is important enough to credit, approve, license or discuss later.

The contributor could confirm the note themselves, or the other collaborators could approve it collectively.

This creates a route from a simple project history towards much richer authorship and contribution records.

## What should actually go on-chain

The system should not put every save on-chain. That would create unnecessary cost and friction.

Instead, it could anchor meaningful milestones:

1. Project created
2. Initial collaborators confirmed
3. Participation statement signed
4. Equal or custom split agreed
5. New collaborator added
6. Credits approved
7. Session completed
8. Demo exported
9. Arrangement approved
10. Mix approved
11. Master approved
12. Final agreement signed
13. Release version confirmed
14. Licence or sample clearance attached

All the saves between these events could remain local.

At the end of a session, Xtrata could combine the checkpoint hashes into a Merkle root or another compact summary and anchor that single result on-chain.

This would prove that the detailed local history existed at that point without publishing the project files, private negotiations or unreleased music.

## **Public and private information**

Not every agreement should be publicly readable.

The Project Passport could separate information into different visibility levels.

### **Public**

- Project identity
- Confirmed collaborators
- Approved credits
- Release information
- Final version hash

### **Shared with collaborators**

- Proposed credits
- Proposed percentages
- Contribution notes
- Session history
- Approval status

### **Private or encrypted**

- Financial terms
- Personal information

- Unreleased lyrics
- Confidential agreements
- Contact details
- Disputes or negotiation notes

The chain could contain hashes proving that these records existed without revealing their contents.

The people authorised to view them could decrypt the underlying documents when required.

## What happens when the project is reopened

When someone opens the project, the Xtrata extension could display a small status panel:

### **Xtrata Project Passport**

Project: Working Title  
 Recognised collaborators: A, B and C  
 Current agreement: Equal composition split  
 Agreement status: Signed by all participants  
 Last confirmed checkpoint: 23 July 2026  
 Current project status: Verified continuation  
 Unanchored changes: 17

The project would continually remind users that the work has an established collaborative and contractual history.

This would be particularly valuable when a project is passed between producers, mixers, labels, managers, publishers or other studios.

## What happens if somebody copies the project

Xtrata cannot prevent somebody from copying a Logic or Ableton project and removing the extension.

What it can do is make the lineage visible.

If someone copies an existing project, the copy would still derive from a previously hashed state. If they remove Xtrata and continue working, the original verified history would end at the last recognised checkpoint.

If Xtrata is later reintroduced, the system could identify the new version as:

- A verified continuation
- An unverified continuation
- A branch
- A fork from an earlier checkpoint
- A project with no recognised relationship to the original passport

Copying would therefore create a branch rather than erasing the existence of the earlier project, its collaborators or their agreements.

This is similar to the way source-code repositories preserve the history of branches and forks, but applied to music production.

## What the system could demonstrate

Depending on how it is used, Xtrata could provide evidence of:

- When a project was created
- Which identities acknowledged participation
- Which terms they signed
- Which credits they approved
- Which ownership or royalty percentages they accepted
- Which version of an agreement was active
- Which project state existed at a particular time
- Whether a later file descends from an earlier file
- When collaborators were added
- When significant exports were created
- Whether a local history has been altered or interrupted
- Which version was approved as the mix or master
- The chain of custody as the project moved between people

The legal effect of a particular agreement would still depend on its wording, the participants' identities, applicable law and the surrounding circumstances.

Xtrata's role would be to make the agreement process clearer, earlier, easier to verify and much harder to rewrite retrospectively.

## The most practical implementation

The strongest first product would probably not be a complex native extension for every DAW.

It could begin as a **DAW-independent desktop companion application** that watches a selected project folder.

The companion application would:

- Create the Project Passport
- Offer agreement templates
- Generate participant signing links
- Record credits and percentages
- Watch the project and media files
- Create checkpoints when files change
- Maintain the local history
- Anchor selected milestones through Xtrata
- Display verification and agreement status
- Export a portable provenance and agreement report

A small AU, VST3 or DAW-specific plugin could then be added primarily as a visible interface inside the project.



Its main purpose would be to show status, trigger checkpoints, display the recognised collaborators and make any current agreements impossible to overlook.

This hybrid structure would be easier to support across Logic, Ableton, Pro Tools, FL Studio, Reaper and other applications than rebuilding the complete monitoring system separately inside every DAW.

## The local Xtrata file

Each project folder could contain a small portable file such as:

```
project-name.xtrata
```

This file would contain:

- The project identity
- Collaborator attestations
- Agreement versions
- Credits
- Percentages
- Signature records
- Checkpoint history
- On-chain references
- Visibility and encryption settings

It would not need to contain the actual music or private DAW contents.

The file could travel with the project when the folder is copied or transferred.

Sensitive information could be encrypted, while the hashes needed for verification could remain visible.

## A simple first-session experience

A producer opens Xtrata and chooses **Create Project Passport**.

Xtrata detects the Logic or Ableton project and creates its initial hash.

The producer chooses what the group is being asked to confirm:

- Participation only
- Equal split
- Custom split
- Credits
- Session terms
- Full agreement

A QR code appears.

Everyone involved scans it and reviews:

- Their name or pseudonym

- Their wallet, passkey or identity
- Their role
- Their proposed credit
- Their proposed percentage, where applicable
- The exact statement or terms being signed

Xtrata collects the approvals and anchors one transaction.

During the session, project saves are checkpointed locally.

At the end of the session, the producer selects **Close Session**. Xtrata anchors a summary of the day's history and optionally records a rough mix.

The next time the project opens, it might display:

This project began as a collaboration between A, B and C. All three participants agreed to an equal composition split. The last verified session ended at 23:47 on 23 July 2026.

That would introduce a significant cultural change.

Collaboration would no longer begin as an undocumented assumption, and agreements would no longer need to wait until memories, expectations and relationships had already diverged.

## Later expansion

Once this skeleton exists, more advanced layers could be added without changing the original Project Passport.

### Credits layer

Participants propose and approve performing, writing, production and technical credits.

### Agreement layer

The collaborators sign plain-language collaboration agreements, split sheets and project-specific terms.

### Asset layer

Individual stems, samples, lyrics, MIDI files, presets and recordings receive their own provenance and licensing records.

### Contribution layer

Important creative changes are attributed to particular participants without exposing the entire project.

### Approval layer

Artists, producers, labels and other stakeholders approve specific mixes, masters and deliverables.

## Licensing layer

Rights holders attach permitted uses, territories, durations, attribution requirements and payment conditions.

## Royalty layer

Revenue can be routed according to the active agreement recorded in the Project Passport.

## Full on-chain production layer

Projects that require complete permanence could progressively move audio, instruments, automation, arrangements and playback logic into Xtrata-native formats such as BVSTs.

## Relationship with Bitcoin and Ordinals

Xtrata could provide the inexpensive, composable working layer where the project history and agreements develop.

For particularly important milestones, such as the final master, definitive credits or a major rights agreement, the project could optionally create a more permanent Bitcoin-level anchor or inscription.

That creates a sensible hierarchy:

- Local checkpoints for frequent activity
- Xtrata transactions for collaboration, agreements and milestones
- Bitcoin or Ordinals anchoring for selected permanent artefacts

The expensive and permanent layer would be used deliberately rather than on every save.

## The larger opportunity

The product is not simply blockchain inside a DAW.

It is a **portable trust, agreement and provenance protocol for creative projects**.

Logic, Ableton and Pro Tools would merely be the first environments in which it operates.

The same Project Passport could eventually follow a work through:

- Songwriting
- Production
- Mixing
- Mastering
- Artwork
- Video
- Distribution
- Publishing
- Licensing
- Performance

- Sampling
- Remixing
- Archiving

Every stage could extend the same history rather than creating disconnected records and paperwork after the creative process has already finished.

## Recommended first product

### Working name: Xtrata Proof of Session

Its first promise could be:

Start every music project with a shared, verifiable record of who was involved and what they agreed.

The minimum viable product would provide:

1. A desktop companion application
2. A portable `.xtrata` Project Passport
3. Participation, credit and split templates
4. Equal and custom percentage agreements
5. Wallet, passkey or guest participant signing
6. Sponsored or aggregated transactions
7. Versioned agreements and approvals
8. Local tamper-evident checkpoints
9. On-chain session and milestone anchors
10. Project branching and lineage detection
11. A simple provenance, credits and agreement report

This would not attempt to revolutionise the entire music industry in one release.

It would introduce one new habit at the most important possible moment:

**Before memories differ, relationships change and arguments begin, the people creating the music record who was involved, what they contributed and what they agreed.**